Choose a graph for the data

I can… distinguish categorical, numerical, and changing-over-time data.

Ask what the answers represent

Question	Data
Favorite fruit?	Categorical
Number of pets?	Numerical
Plant height each week?	Changes over time

Match a representation

A bar graph compares categories. A line plot shows frequencies of numerical values. A line graph shows how a measured quantity changes over time.

Plan a time-based question

"How does our plant's height change each week?" Record the date and height each time.